

DELHI | Escape to Victory



SIPRA DAS

For the national football team, there seems to be no better hunting ground than Ambedkar Stadium in the capital. Last week, after a sluggish start to the 14th Nehru Cup tournament, India once again emerged winners, defeating Syria 5-4 via a tie-breaker. It was the third international trophy that the boys in blue

THE INDIAN TEAM AFTER WINNING THE NEHRU CUP

have won in as many years, following the Nehru cup victory in 2007 and the Asian Football Confederation (AFC) Challenge Cup a year later. Last year's victory in the AFC has earned India a place in the Asia Cup scheduled to be held in Qatar in 2011 where they'll be pitted against Asian soccer giants like Japan, South Korea and Saudi Arabia. A two-time Asian Games gold medal winner and a semi-finalist at the

Melbourne Olympics, India had fallen by the wayside in recent years. The arrival of Englishman Bob Houghton as coach, who took Sweden's Malmo to European Cup glory in the 1980s, has changed the team's fortunes in the last two years. From here, the goal can only get easier.

by Rahul Tewari

Fight Club

The war between Minister of State Shashi Tharoor and his predecessor E. Ahamed is hotting up. Kerala Congress leaders who have been briefing Sonia Gandhi about the strife have been instructed to ensure a ceasefire between the two ministers.

DELHI | No Defence

It's not just howitzers. The army is critically short of modern anti-aircraft guns. The bulk of its defences are still handled by the venerable L-70 ack-ack gun which debuted after World War II. With faster aircraft and new threats like UAVs and cruise missiles, the gun is hopelessly outdated. Two years ago the army went shopping to replace nearly 1,200 of the guns. Bids were sent out to global vendors twice but only Germany's Rheinmetall, which produces the Skyshield cannon, responded both times. To avoid a single vendor situation, the Defence Acquisition Council asked the Ordnance Factory Board (OFB) to firm up

a joint venture with Rheinmetall last year. But last month, the Defence Ministry asked the OFB to scrap this JV and asked the army to issue fresh tenders. The beginning of another endlessly painful gun saga.

by Sandeep Unnithan

THE L-70 GUN



DELHI | Top Rated

It was the TV Today Network all the way at the Indian News Broadcasting Awards 2009, proving once again that it is India's number one news network. TV Today Network walked away with three awards—Best News Producer (English), Sujay Bhattacharya of Headlines Today; Best Editor-In-Chief (Hindi), Q.W. Naqvi, and Best News TV CEO, G. Krishnan. TV Today has been winning awards



G. KRISHNAN, CEO AND EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR OF TV TODAY

across all categories for the last eight years. Aaj Tak has won the prestigious Best News Channel award eight times in a row. Krishnan said, "I am delighted TV Today has always been recognised as a pioneer for creating and expanding the television news category." Aroon Purie, CMD of TV Today, said, "It is a great honour for TV Today to get recognised for its excellence and pioneering effort in the news space." ■